# 10



# UNUSUAL FACTS

## ABOUT AD FRAUD

What’s really happening behind the scenes of digital advertising

FraudScore

1

Malicious SDKs can drain smartphone batteries by simulating real users and continuously generating fake views, clicks, and in-app activity.

They basically turn your phone into a bot farm node without you ever noticing.

2

Fraudsters use home Wi-Fi networks and rented devices to produce natural-looking IP addresses and geolocations.

Your neighbor’s router might be powering a botnet right now, and no one would see it on the surface.

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3

**Retargeting often creates the illusion of effectiveness by intercepting users who would have bought anyway.**

It turns natural buyer behavior into an artificially inflated success metric, tricking marketers into overvaluing campaigns.

4

**Around 30% of all industry traffic is fraudulent (web, mobile, and CTV).**

In certain regions, advertisers buy more bots than humans, and don’t even know it.

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5

## One single IP address can consume up to 40% of an advertiser’s budget through automated impression bursts.

Device farms create "over-concentration": tens of thousands of impressions and clicks from a single source, making it appear organic.

6

## Fake websites increasingly impersonate major publishers.

Advertisers think they’re buying CNN, but end up paying top CPM for a fake blog with zero humans.

7

**Some bots "sleep" for up to 10 hours a day to mimic natural human behavior patterns.**

Such pauses help botnets avoid detection and appear more like real users.

8

**Fraudsters often mix in 5-10% real users into their traffic to reduce suspicion.**

This tactic makes fraud nearly invisible even to advanced detection systems.

9

## Redirect chains are used to generate false ad clicks.

Advertisers pay for impressions and clicks that don’t lead to real engagement, inflating performance metrics.

10

## Competitors or malicious bots may deliberately click on your ads to drain your marketing budget.

This makes campaigns look costly while delivering no real engagement.

# WANT MORE

## INSIGHTS ABOUT AD FRAUD?

Follow FraudScore for trends, investigations, and real data from the anti-fraud industry

**Stay informed. Stay protected.**

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